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COMPANY DEEP-DIVE

Chief AI Officer at OSF Digital Believes Salesforce's Agentforce Platform Is Driving Accelerated Enterprise AI Adoption

DATE PUBLISHED	INTERVIEW DATE	EXPERT PERSPECTIVE	ANALYST PERSPECTIVE	PRIMARY COMPANY
18 Aug 2026	04 Aug 2026	Partner	Investor-Led (Buy-Side)	CRM

SMART SUMMARY

Summary

The conversation covered the evolving adoption of AI and agentic solutions in the enterprise space, focusing on Salesforce's Agentforce platform, integration with other technologies, and changes in client engagement and project models.

EXPERT BACKGROUND

- Chief AI Officer and Founder at a digital systems integrator with deep experience implementing AI and agentic solutions for enterprise clients, particularly leveraging Salesforce and integrating with other major platforms.

EXPERT SENTIMENT

- **The expert is optimistic about the accelerating adoption and maturity of AI and agentic solutions among enterprise clients, noting a significant increase in both project size and urgency**.
- They believe **Salesforce is well-positioned for enterprise AI adoption, despite public market skepticism and comparisons to consumer-focused AI companies like OpenAI and Anthropic**.
- The expert sees the shift to outcome-based project models and the need for simplified pricing as major industry changes that will impact both integrators and Salesforce.

TAKEAWAYS

- **Enterprise adoption of Agentforce and AI solutions is accelerating, with project sizes growing from tens of thousands** to mid six figures and usage metrics (such as token consumption) showing a 'hockey stick' growth pattern.
- Clients are increasingly sophisticated and educated about AI, leading to more complex, multi-agent, and cross-platform integrations involving Salesforce, OpenAI, Anthropic, Azure, SAP, and others.
- **About 20% of the expert's client base is in serious production with Agentforce, with another 20-30% expected to ramp up** significantly in the next six months.
- The shift from time-and-materials to outcome-based and fixed-scope projects is a major trend for system integrators, requiring adaptation in business models.
- Salesforce's Headless 360 initiative and deeper AI integration (including recent acquisitions) are seen as important enablers, but pricing and consumption models remain complex and in need of simplification.

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Expert Bio

Chief AI Officer, Founder at OSF Digital Expert can speak to digital expansion, market development, and growth strategy. Chief AI Officer, Founder at OSF Digital. The expert is responsible for providing strategic direction for OSF Digital’s international expansion, market development, partnerships, and product innovation. The expert leads efforts to position the company as a global digital transformation and commerce leader within the Salesforce ecosystem. Collaborating with cross-functional teams, the expert ensures the delivery of tailored, high-impact solutions for both B2B and B2C clients, including custom applications when needed. Central to their mission is building an ecosystem that meets all digital transformation needs, integrating AI and productivity tools to enhance delivery, accelerate go-to-market efforts, and maintain a strong focus on innovation, evidenced by the launch of over 30 Business Accelerators, Apps, and Products. The expert can speak to anything related to AI, growth strategy, driving growth, company management, and global expansion.

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Interview Transcript

Client 00:00:00

Hi there, thanks for taking the time. I wanted to maybe get a sense of how the year has progressed for you, both in terms of new projects, how Agentforce is tracking relative to your expectations, and then, to the extent that you have insight, how the consumption patterns at your clients are evolving.

Expert 00:00:18

First of all, Agentforce, and **you can see it also from their quarterly earnings reports, is moving ahead quite nicely**. It could be faster, but I think that's highly dependent on the nature of the customer Salesforce has. We are seeing two stories. We are seeing these explosive stories coming from OpenAI and Anthropic with a lot of usage and users are using it left and right, but we don't see the same type of explosive adoption on Agentforce. Even if Agentforce is being adopted, but not to the same extent.

The reason is that Salesforce sells into businesses, enterprises. A lot of their licenses comes from commercial and enterprise level customers. Meanwhile, the other ones are a lot of user licenses. The user licenses are way bigger than the enterprise licenses. I can see it also in the way enterprises approach buying AI. They are way more cautious. They test it. They do more of a POC. They are much more careful about liability, about the data security, while the end user, they don't really care that much about all of these topics. That's a very different end customer.

The buying patterns are very different. However, I'm seeing lately the market warming up, more and more and getting more confident in actually buying AI, and everything that it involves. I'm seeing, especially now in the second and third quarter of the year, things picking up around Agentforce, but not only Agentforce. One interesting thing that I'm seeing is that it's not really just an Agentforce conversation that is happening whenever we engage with the customers.

It's a much more, a bigger picture conversation where it's about Agentforce, but also about data and oftentimes customers require us to bring in another AI platform such as OpenAI or Anthropic and connect the agents, from within Salesforce with outside agents and provide them some more guidance in how to manage an agentic platform for themselves. That's where this is going. This is what I'm seeing from where I stand. Salesforce is getting better and better and maturing around AI use cases. Probably you've seen that they've announced the Headless 360 initiative.

Opening up basically to be able to use the platform just through APIs, so no UI involved. That's also a very big step forward, especially in an AI world where agents have to query the platforms, not through a UI, but really going directly through an API, going directly through the data. That's another big step forward, I would say, from my point of view. That's a big step forward. I believe it will help Salesforce in being adopted by the market. Long answer, I know, but there's a lot of nuances there.

Client 00:03:24

Yeah. When you say that the market is warming up, how would you characterize that? What does that practically mean in terms of the engagements that you're working on, what your clients are doing with Salesforce, these more complex, or maybe not complex, but these multi-party deals with an OpenAI or an Anthropic, how is Salesforce being used versus how are the labs being used?

Expert 00:03:49

Maybe let me define a little bit better what I mean by warming up. It's not just the willingness to buy Agentforce, but also, I would say, them being much more prepared to buy something like this. The types of questions that we would get one year ago were a little bit ridiculous. I can see now that the customers are much more educated about AI and about capabilities and also about the challenges. They understand much better the nuances of security and compliance around AI. Accountability is a big topic. Nobody sues an agent, but everybody sues a company or a person. That's a very important thing generally for enterprises.

They are going from, I would say, a simple customer-facing agent that would answer to basic FAQ questions from customers, into much more sophisticated operations where you have multiple agents working with each other to deliver results for their end customers, but also can be something in-house that they have been envisioning. These things are getting much more complex, and that's what I mean when I say warming up. On one hand, **they understand the capabilities and the potential much, much better** than a year ago and even six months ago. On the other hand, they are way more educated and prepared to get themselves into this new adventure.

Client 00:05:14

What does that mean in terms of the amount of work or client adoption, or any way to think about how quantitatively Agentforce is progressing among your client base?

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Expert 00:05:24

I would say that while **overall projects around the core Salesforce platform are growing in the single digits, everything Agentforce is growing into double digits**, in north of 20%, in terms of business. That is to give you a sense of what do I mean by this. Does that make sense?

Client 00:05:44

Yeah. How is that translating, or how are the use cases for Agentforce evolving? What are you seeing in terms of where the demand for new Agentforce use cases is coming from now?

Expert 00:05:56

OSF as a company interacts with multiple departments within enterprises. We see different angles. We see it from the customer support organizations, but we also see it from marketing, and we also see it around everything that is B2B support, B2B processing, the supply chain management. Especially since Salesforce acquired Regrello, which now is Agentforce supply chain management. It gives you a much bigger view into the way the customer are using AI.

Generally, the way it happens is that we start talking to one of these groups, and gradually, we get involved into other groups and other use cases. It's very interesting how once they see the actual potential for AI, then themselves are bringing us in into other areas. This is the organic move, but also what we are doing is we are interacting at the executive level. Because for many companies, the AI is a strategic initiative, so you end up talking to the CEO or the board, really at C-level. They will also put you into several conversations around AI.

That's how you end up in conversations where initially you were talking about building one agent for them, and you end up on a roadmap to deliver 20+ agents. I've had exactly this type of setup just last week with a customer where we, instead of signing a couple of agents, ended up signing for 21 agents to be set up. Now, this is a mix between Agentforce, Salesforce, but also external agents that would be specialized on some different areas of the business.

Client 00:07:34

Where does that line between Agentforce and other agents, where does that get drawn? When do you bring in something else when you're doing these projects?

Expert 00:07:46

Once a company gets a little bit bigger, they tend to standardize around a certain platform. For example, they are much more comfortable in working with Amazon or working with Microsoft, or working more with Salesforce. Depending on how they engage with these platforms, they would tend to have preferences. For example, if you are a Google company, you tend to work with Google Docs, in order to get easier access into that platform, building some agentic capabilities around the Google platform makes much more sense.

Integrating it with Agentforce, with an agent-to-agent capability, then it makes more sense. If you are on Microsoft, then building something with Azure, using their infrastructure and then connecting into Agentforce, that's also the way that customers would prefer to do. These are the nuances on how they already have their infrastructure set up. Sometimes it can happen that some of the requirements that they have, it's about interacting with their SAP system, and you need to build an MCP server or an infrastructure that they already have. You choose also the models based on what they currently have, and then you integrate that into the Salesforce infrastructure through an agent-to-agent interface.

That's how it generally happens. I've been rarely put in a situation where they wanted to do just pure Salesforce because their reality is different. There's no company that has just 100% Salesforce. You have companies that have more Salesforce than others, and depending on how much Salesforce they have versus other platforms that they already engage with, the solution will also depend on that.

Maybe to nuance this a little bit more, this is because when we are talking to them about agentic, the conversation starts with Salesforce because **that's where our strong positioning** is. It evolves very quickly into, "Okay, but then how am I integrating with this platform, and how can we make them work? Can you build something on this for me as well?" Since we have that knowledge, since we have that capability in working with other platforms and other AI, it is easy for us to propose something that makes sense for them, from a business point of view, and having a Salesforce-centric architecture, but with a lot of add-ons from other platforms and other LLMs.

Client 00:10:06

As you think about the types of deals that you're doing with Agentforce now versus six months ago or a year ago, has the type of POC, the size of the POC, the customer's willingness to commit changed at all? What do the initial projects look like versus what they were a year ago?

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Expert 00:10:23
This is like night and day. Last year, towards the H2 second half of the year, I remember we would talk about building POCs into the tens of thousands. That was the ticket size. This year, now we are talking about projects that will end up being mid six figures. This has changed dramatically. We are talking about a different scale, a different reality now.

Client 00:10:49
Has the amount of time that clients spend on that stage changed? Are they more willing to go to a full production agent? Has the proportion of clients that are in production changed materially?

Expert 00:11:04
Last year, we were dealing with a lot of POCs and demos and these kind of things. It was important for them, but since they didn't know how to approach it, timelines were fluid, and you didn't have that crisp sense of urgency. Meanwhile, this year is about, once they see that, "Hey, you are the trusted partner that will implement something that we want," then the question is, "Can you start like yesterday? Let's get this done. Let's put this out as soon as possible." That's what I see now happening again and again. Meanwhile, yesterday was like, "Let's hurry up and wait."

Client 00:11:44
I know that Salesforce is making usage a big evaluation point for partners and even their own salespeople. Are you tracking your clients' usage? Are you able to see once they're deployed, how they're using it and how it's expanding?

Expert 00:11:59
It depends on the customer, because sometimes they want to drive it themselves, and we're not necessarily given access to everything, depending on how the contract is structured. In most cases, yes, we can see usage. I would say the big majority of cases, **the usage tends to grow** because we involve also their end users in this process. It's not just something that is being driven by our customer's executive layer, but it's really into the users of this. That's why adoption is also going somewhat easier.

Client 00:12:31
Got it. From the usage perspective, how fast is **it growing from whatever metric** you can track or an aggregate? I think part of where **people try and criticize Agentforce** is they've sold a lot of customers, but there's not a lot of usage. What are the usage trends you see?

Expert 00:12:50
Let me give you in terms of tokens, because now everybody understands token consumptions. I have had a customer that towards the beginning of this year, the token consumption was in the thousands, under $5,000 worth of tokens. This, towards June, July, token consumption was over $50,000 in terms of number of tokens burned. **The usage picked up** significantly from the beginning of the year. It's a hockey stick curve, if you want, in terms of adoption.

That's what we see, and it's not uncommon. I think also the employees and users within those enterprises are much more in tune with what AI can do and how to approach AI. They don't hesitate that much as they used to one year ago. You can see that in usage and adoption. I think Salesforce made it a thing to separate Agentforce from everything else and present it as a metric and everything. I think we will have a very interesting quarterly earnings report the next time that they will present Agentforce and agentic in general.

Client 00:14:00
What do you mean?

Expert 00:14:02
At least from what we can see, **the usage will have picked up** nicely. That's what I'm saying. At least based on what I can see with our customers. I can't speak for their entire user base, but I'm getting the same types of inputs from our competitors. I maintain friendly relationships with some of our competitors, and they are talking about the same things.

Client 00:14:27
No, they've been giving the chart now of agentic work units and tokens every quarter that they've seen. From Q4 of last year to one of this year, **the usage really accelerated.** That's why I'm curious, are **you seeing that accelerating growth in usage**, that hockey stick, as you said, or is it just explosive growth?

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Expert 00:14:48

Yeah. This is driven by enterprises being much more comfortable in dealing with AI and buying AI. More comfortable than they were one year ago. This entire AI world was driven a lot by users like me and you, but not really companies buying AI. Now, this year especially, which is very important for Salesforce, it is the enterprises that are driving the usage. This is where it goes.

Finally, you can see that within companies, people take AI seriously, not just as a gimmick and, I don't know if you've seen in the press, every time that they have to make cuts on their workforce, they use AI as an excuse. There is a lot of AI washing in this. I can see it from a point of view of AI usage and tokens and everything, that things are picking up and start being quite serious in this enterprise world.

Client 00:15:41

What percent of your customer base now is in what I would think of as real production on an Agentforce use case? Say 90% of your customers were doing something with Agentforce, but it wasn't really production level. How would you think about the adoption and then how many are really using it right now?

Expert 00:16:01

I would say about 20% are really serious about it. There is another 20%-30%, I would have to check back on my numbers, but I would say another 20%-30% that will do something more significant in the next six months. There are always **some laggards** because especially the bigger the company gets, it feels like that the slower they move. We have some laggards also in terms of adoption. Even the laggards are doing something. It's not that they are not doing anything, it's just that the speed of deployment and what they are doing might not be as sophisticated as others.

Client 00:16:41

What are the most interesting use cases you've done over the last three to six months with Agentforce? What's the easiest sell, and then what are the ones where you think you're really differentiating because it's on Salesforce or Salesforce really, **they won because it was** something that they could do better versus just them being an option and an existing vendor, for example?

Expert 00:17:02

One interesting one is we have a customer that, because this is still in progress, asked us to build a series of agents to help their Salesforce from capturing the leads helping their sales reps to have a very intelligent conversation based on their entire knowledge base, based on the customer profile, based on everything else that we can find about them in the publicly available information, through many platforms integrated.

Have a point of view, open up a conversation, then drive them into actually help them building RFPs, putting that information together for RFPs, throughout all the data sources from within the company, throughout multiple BUs, because this is also the complexity. They have seven Salesforce orgs from different units. Putting it all together into a real proposal and working with estimates and having agents at every step of the way and building the entire process whereby you put humans in the loop for each step and make sure that there is accountability everywhere, there is traceability. Everything that the agents are doing and/or proposing is tracked, and you can always go back one step if you need to, and so on and so forth.

It's really like this entire view on how this organization works. That is quite an interesting process. It is mostly Salesforce, but it is also with a lot of things from outside Salesforce to bring into this agentic architecture to drive this new process. It was quite interesting because it involved multiple units from the customer. It involved multiple platforms. It involved different LLMs because we don't want to use frontier models for simple stuff. It would cost an arm and a leg. This was quite an interesting use case.

Client 00:18:53

What were the other technologies that they brought in to make this use case work?

Expert 00:18:58

They had Azure. On top of Azure, they wanted to use from Anthropic, they wanted to use some of those models to increase the relevancy of response and the information that we were putting together. Also, because they use Teams as internal communication tool, and they wanted to integrate these agents into Teams, getting information from their SharePoint. Integrating that with Agentforce, having that agent-to-agent integration and orchestration, that was quite interesting. They had one integration into their SAP ERP as well. That was quite interesting.

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Client 00:19:34

Got it. Have there been any platform changes on Agentforce that you think have made a difference in terms of driving that incremental usage and adoption? Has there been anything from the technology side that's been part of the unlock here, or is it mostly just the customer maturity?

Expert 00:19:54

I think for us, what really made a difference was customer maturity. Everything else that Salesforce has done did help. For us, what really made the difference is customers getting to a certain maturity. It's like day and night, from what I can tell.

Client 00:20:12

I don't know if you had set internal targets for yourself around just Agentforce adoption usage or what you would see with your clients this year, but how has that tracked relative to your expectations? Whatever your measure of success was going into this year, how do you think with Salesforce specifically that's been going?

Expert 00:20:31

We are aligned with the Salesforce metrics because in order to keep our positioning within Salesforce, we need to deliver on certain agentic adoption metrics. I think we track those quite well. **I don't think there will be any issues** for us to be really well-positioned next time when we review it with Salesforce.

Client 00:20:51

I was thinking more relative to, as a business, your own goals or targets for how things would go this year, how have those trended?

Expert 00:20:59

We have as a target to have about 40% of our business be revolving around AI. We are already tracking towards that number. I think with everything that we have in progress, next year, we should be able to do that 40%. It's very well within reach. This is something that I don't know exactly how the others are tracking this, but for us and for me in particular, it's very important to see how much AI we have in an account and how much that account is AI-enabled with AI revenues driven from the account, and what is the attach rate to anything that AI is generating. We track these metrics. As a whole, in terms of AI-enabled revenue, the goal for next year would be to get at least 40% of the total company revenue to be AI-enabled.

Client 00:21:47

That makes sense as a target. Do you think Salesforce is happy with where the progress is on Agentforce now, just given there was a period of time where I think their go-to-market wasn't exactly where they wanted to be. They weren't seeing the adoption as fast as they thought they would. What do you think the sentiment there is now on just where Agentforce adoption is?

Expert 00:22:11

They say they are, but based on what I know in talking to them, I don't think that **they are happy** with where they are, especially because in the market, there is this comparison to OpenAI and Anthropic and whatnot, and it's just a different customer profile that those companies have. It's not necessarily comparable, but that's what they are comparing themselves against, in terms of market expectation. Nobody goes deeper, like two layers down to understand the differences and the nuances.

From that point of view, I don't think that they are happy enough with where they are, even if in their public communication they say they are. At least, that's my understanding of where they are. I think that it's a bit wrong, because comparing Salesforce to OpenAI is like comparing apples to, not oranges, but to elephants. You're not talking about the same things. I think that, although you've seen the share price not going quite well for Salesforce, and you have this SaaS apocalypse and whatnot, there's a lot of talk about Salesforce disappearing.

I think **that's a lot of nonsense** because Salesforce is well-entrenched with enterprises. It's pretty synced up with what enterprise really wants. The offering is quite mature, in terms of AI, and I think it's quite well-designed. I think Salesforce is where it needs to be. For whenever these people and these types of customers will wake up and say, "Yeah, we want AI. Where do I sign?" Salesforce is going to be right there to sign with the customer. That's why I think that all this talk in the market and etc. around Salesforce, whatever, not being good enough or not having the right adoption or not having this, it's overblown and has nothing to do with the reality of Salesforce's customer profile.

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Client 00:24:01

I would agree with that. Are you doing much with Slack as part of your Agentforce projects? I know they've been positioning that really as much more of a core part of it now. What are your thoughts there?

Expert 00:24:15

Not as much as Salesforce is spouting it. It's on an upswing. I would say that lately, we are having customers wanting to use Slack as the interface, from where you can talk to an agent or drive an agent. This is something that I see more and more. It is not as common. I think it will be once people start seeing the possibilities, and it will require, again, because of the type of customer that we are talking here about, they also have their budgeting cycles and everything. You cannot just dream up budget in a company. It's not like in your personal expenses today, you want to spend $200 more on Anthropic, you do that, and you give up on going to the movies or whatever.

With enterprises, that's not the same approach. It requires some time, budgeting cycles. It requires a little bit more time. I know that there are some of our customers who are looking into this Slack UI as being the interface to their agents. At least that's providing one way of interacting with agents. I see some of our customers wanting to be able to interact with the agents in multiple ways. We have one customer who wants to do a Slack interface, who wants to create a mobile app so that you can actually talk to the agent through the pure voice interaction.

Also will build a UI that you can use through your desktop to interact with the agents. You will have three ways of interacting with the agents in very different ways. Each interface has its pluses and minuses, so you'll have to adjust and adapt to those limitations or capabilities. Slack is, in my opinion, interacting with Salesforce will become a thing towards the end of this year, next year. They will probably have a big topic around this at Salesforce. I know we are preparing a demo around exactly this topic.

Client 00:26:11

Where is Headless now, both in terms of the strategy? Are your clients asking about it or is anyone doing anything with it? What seems to be the rationale for clients who want to start developing on Headless?

Expert 00:26:25

It's still early. We have customers who are looking into it. It requires a heavy investment in order to build your head because Headless without a head doesn't really work. Those have to be very sophisticated enterprises in how to manage it. I think, from my point of view, that's already an enterprise-level product where you need to have a serious budget around this and some serious thinking on how to make it happen.

This is not going to be like a $10,000 project. Yes, this is quite big, especially from an AI point of view. I think, for the moment being right now, Headless is much more of an enabler for the AI deployment than anything else. If you want the head to the headless architecture, instead of having a traditional head, like you had in the past, like a desktop UI or a mobile app or whatever other flag or other way of interacting with your entire infrastructure. In this case, AI starts becoming that head and using and interacting with the headless DC.

Client 00:27:32

Any other trends or changes in your business so far this year?

Expert 00:27:36

I think just to complete my answer. I think in terms for Headless, what really made them to open it up and launch this, because you must have read the stories on the Internet, they went back and forth on this. There was a discussion within their group. Should we open it up, should we not? Should we do this? Will this make **us weaker or not**? Obviously, the group that wanted to open it up won. Also, I think that they won because of the AI angle. This is such a nice angle for AI usage and AI architectures, AI orchestration, interacting with the platform that is. I think it was really essential for them to make this move. What was your follow-up question?

Client 00:28:25

I was going to ask, is there anything else in terms of trends or things that you're seeing in your business changes to the way Salesforce business has gone this year that surprised you I haven't asked about?

Expert 00:28:36

From a Salesforce point of view or from us as an integrator point of view?

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Client 00:28:41

Both actually, really. In terms of what you're seeing in the market.

Expert 00:28:46

From a system integrator point of view, one big thing is that slowly this entire time and materials market is shifting and changing. That's maybe not that slowly actually. It's something that is moving forward. I think we will see many more projects that are outcome based, many more projects that are fixed scope, fixed budget, and other more creative way of just aligning with the business results. That, I would say, caused a significant shift, especially for companies that have never done businesses in any other way than just time and material.

You're charging for hours. That is quite a big shift, and **it will disrupt** significantly the way people do business. From our point of view, we've been working on this for quite some time, and even if it's disruptive, I don't think it's going to be that big of a disruption as I'm seeing it for others. That's a big change, and I cannot underestimate or I cannot overstate how big this shift is going to be. It's going to be a very significant change in the way we do business. That's on the system integrator level.

From a Salesforce point of view, I think they would still have to make some adjustments in the way they price AI, but also the way they integrate it with Data Cloud and the way they align it with their tokens and their consumption metrics. **It's still not as good** as it could be, especially now you have Headless 360 also involved. Sometimes, it's almost like you need a PhD to put together pricing for a customer. It's not trivial.

I don't want to say that they suck because it's complex. It's not simple. You have many things involved. You have the LLM, you have your own cloud, you have Data Cloud, you have Headless 360, you have all kinds of clouds in Salesforce. It's a pretty big platform, and it's quite significant, the number of conversations that you can have. It's not that straightforward to come up with something simple and easy to put down on a paper and easy to sell.

They will have to make some bold adjustments to try to simplify and get it to be much easier for the customer to understand pricing and consumption and how does this align with Headless 360, how does this align with the other clouds and data, and so on and so forth. I think those are the areas we will see some more changes. From a Salesforce thing, it is deeper integration with Informatica, which is not really a surprise. That's why they bought it. More AI into everything as they acquired Regrello, which is Agentforce Operations now. We will see probably more acquisitions also to complement their AI agentic initiatives. That's where I see them making some moves.

Client 00:31:42

No, that makes sense. All right. I think that's it for my questions today.

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